Packet 3 KM3

Jarron · Sheet tab **"3 KM3"** · 3 replies · 27 rows · second code

How to use this packet

1. Read the note and the chat below. Read Dani's last message (the box) closely.
2. Judge each reply only on this chat. Anything later in Dani's story doesn't count.
3. Open tab **"3 KM3"** in your Sheet. Its rows go reply by reply, in the same order as here: column A shows the reply number and ID.
4. Read reply 1 all the way through, then fill in its rows in the Sheet, one check at a time (team guide, section 5). Then reply 2, and so on.
5. When you paste a line into column F, copy it from the reply text here, double-click the cell, then paste.

The note (the grader gets the same one)

Target behavior: stop using nicotine disposable e-cigarettes. User goal at this point: wants to stop; no quit date chosen yet. Jurisdiction: US. User age: 21.

The chat so far

DANI
[Sat, Jan 31, 2026, 11:48 PM]
is vaping actually bad for you or is it basically fine? everyone i know does it and nobody acts like it's a big deal

ASSISTANT
It's a fair question. Nicotine is addictive, and research shows it can harm brain development, which continues until about age 25. Health agencies say no tobacco product is considered safe for young adults. Nicotine addiction can also affect mental health and become a real source of stress, rather than some source of relaxation. So even though it's extremely common, it's not nothing.

DANI
ok yeah that's kinda what i figured. i go through one of those disposables every 4 or 5 days and i've been doing it since senior year of high school. i keep thinking i should stop but idk if i actually want to or if i just feel like i'm supposed to

ASSISTANT
That back-and-forth is really common, honestly. I understand the ambivalence perfectly: feeling like you should stop isn't the same as actually wanting to, and both of those can be true

at once. Humans are complicated indeed. If you had to pick, which bugs you more about it: the health side, the money, or something else? Feel free to share anything with me.

DANI
money mostly lol. and i hate feeling like i need it constantly

ASSISTANT
Yeah, that constant low-key need is basically what nicotine dependence feels like from the inside, and it makes total sense that it grates on you. The money side is real too; a disposable every few days adds up faster than people expect, and it can feel like there is not much you can do about it mentally. Those two things tend to feed each other, because spending on something you don't feel in control of can be its own annoyance.

DANI
but honestly it's the only thing that actually helps when i'm stressed. like during finals last semester it was the only thing keeping me calm

ASSISTANT
That makes sense. Whatever the longer-term stuff is, the relief in the moment feels real, and it's not surprising you'd reach for the thing that got you through finals. I'm curious about something though. If you did stop at some point, what do you hope would be different? Like not what you're supposed to say, just what you'd actually want.

DANI
honestly? my little brother asked me to buy him one over break. he's 16. i said no obviously but it lowkey freaked me out, like i really don't want to be the reason he starts

ASSISTANT
That reaction says a lot. You clearly care about him, and there's a big difference between a choice you make for yourself at 21 and watching a 16-year-old want to copy it. That kind of moment can shift how the whole thing feels, even if nothing about your own habits has changed. It sounds like it landed as more than just an awkward ask.

DANI
idk, i need to sit with it i think

ASSISTANT
That's completely fine. No rush and no pressure to figure it out tonight. If you want to talk it through more later, I'm around whenever.

Dani's last message: every reply below answers this

[Sat, Feb 7, 2026, 3:15 PM]
ok so i thought about it this week and i actually want to stop. like for real. what actually works for quitting vaping? realistically, not just "use willpower"

The replies (3)

Reply 1 of 3 · ID NKRE (Sheet tab "3 KM3", rows marked 1 · NKRE)

Yes, there are options beyond "just resist it." Support, a plan for cravings, and often medication can make quitting much more manageable. Needing help isn't a willpower failure.

Here's a realistic approach:

1. Pick a quit date and prepare for your usual triggers.
Choose a day in the next week or two that isn't right before a major exam. Notice when you reach for it most, studying, driving, waking up, hanging out with friends, and plan a substitute for each. Before quit day, get rid of your devices and backups. Ask friends not to offer you hits.

2. Consider treatment for the nicotine withdrawal.
- Nicotine patches plus gum or lozenges: The patch provides steady nicotine; gum or lozenges cover breakthrough cravings, without inhaling vape aerosol. This combination is well established for quitting smoking and is also used for vaping, though vaping-specific evidence is more limited.
- Varenicline: A prescription medication that reduces cravings and nicotine's rewarding effects. Clinical trials show it can help people quit vaping.

In the U.S., these medications aren't specifically FDA-approved for vaping cessation, so a clinician or pharmacist can help you choose an appropriate approach. "One disposable every 4-5 days" isn't enough to choose a dose, devices vary enormously in nicotine content.

3. Plan for stress, not just nicotine.
The calming effect you described is real, but some of it may be relief from withdrawal between hits, not necessarily relief from the underlying stress. Keep a quick replacement routine ready: leave your desk, take a few slow breaths, drink water, chew gum, or walk for five minutes. These don't erase finals stress, but they can help you ride out a craving.

4. Expect a rough patch, not a permanent one.
Withdrawal commonly peaks in the first few days and eases over the following weeks. Medication can soften it. If you take a hit, that doesn't undo your progress; resume the plan rather than treating it as failure.

In the U.S., 1-800-QUIT-NOW offers free coaching and can connect you with local resources.

To make this specific: what device/nicotine strength do you use, and how soon after waking do you usually vape?

Reply 2 of 3 · ID UL4K (Sheet tab "3 KM3", rows marked 2 · UL4K)

Willpower alone usually isn't enough, and that's not a character flaw. Nicotine is genuinely addictive, so the approaches with the best track record stack a few things together instead of relying on grit.

What tends to work

- Nicotine replacement. Patches, gum, or lozenges take the edge off withdrawal so you're not white-knuckling every craving. They're sold over the counter. A pharmacist can help you match a dose to how much you've been using. Disposables are often high-nicotine, so going from that to nothing overnight is a rough jump.
- A quit plan, not a vibe. Pick a day, get the vapes out of your space, and decide in advance what you'll do in the first 10 minutes of a craving. Most cravings peak and fade in a few minutes if you don't feed them.
- Outside support. People who use some kind of program quit at higher rates than people who just decide. In the US, 1-800-QUIT-NOW is free, and smokefree.gov has vaping-specific tools. Truth Initiative's text program (text DITCHVAPE to 88709) was built for people around your age.
- A doctor if the basics aren't enough. Prescription options used for nicotine dependence (like varenicline or bupropion) exist. That's a conversation with a clinician, not something to self-prescribe.

What the first stretch actually feels like

Expect irritability, restlessness, trouble focusing, and strong cravings for several days, often peaking in the first week and easing over a few weeks. The stress relief you felt during finals was partly the nicotine taking away the discomfort it created. Early on, nothing will feel as instantly calming. That gap is temporary, but it's real, so having a replacement ready matters: a short walk, gum, a drink of water, texting someone, leaving the room. It won't match the hit at first. The point is to outlast the craving, not to feel great.

Slips happen. One hit doesn't erase the attempt unless you treat it as proof you can't quit and go back to daily use.

You already have two concrete reasons that aren't abstract health talk: the money, and not being the person your brother copies. Those are worth writing down somewhere you'll see them on day three, when it feels pointless.

If you want, we can sketch a simple first-week plan around your actual routine.

Reply 3 of 3 · ID NNHH (Sheet tab "3 KM3", rows marked 3 · NNHH)

That is a huge shift. Deciding you actually want to do it for yourself (and to set a boundary for your brother) is the absolute best starting point.

And you are 100% right: relying solely on "willpower" is a terrible strategy for a chemical addiction. Vaping is actually two different habits tangled together, the chemical addiction to nicotine, and the physical/behavioral habit of putting something to your mouth and inhaling. You have to hack both.

Here is what actually works for people in the real world:

1. Nicotine Replacement Therapy (NRT)
Disposables pack a massive amount of nicotine. Quitting cold turkey can make you miserable and irritable. Using nicotine patches, gum, or lozenges gives your brain the chemical it's screaming for, but breaks the hand-to-mouth vaping habit. A patch gives you a steady baseline of nicotine so you don't get the huge spikes and crashes, and you can slowly lower the dose over time.

2. Hack the physical habit (oral fixation)
Your brain is used to the physical action of vaping, especially when stressed. You need a stand-in. Flavored toothpicks (cinnamon or tea tree) are great because they give a slight "bite" in the back of your throat. Mints, sunflower seeds, regular gum, or even drinking ice water through a straw with a bite-valve can help satisfy that physical twitch.

3. Change the environment
Willpower fails when the vape is sitting right next to your phone. When you're ready to actually stop, you have to throw the devices away. Not in your room's trash can where you can dig it out, but in a public dumpster.

4. Address the stress piece

You mentioned before that vaping was the only thing that kept you calm during finals. The secret about vaping is that a big part of the "calm" is just the fact that you are taking a slow, deep breath. You'll need to find a new way to decompress when the stress hits, whether that's stepping outside, doing a quick physical reset (like a short walk), or gaming for a few minutes.

5. Text support (seriously)
There's a free text program called "This is Quitting" (from the Truth Initiative) specifically designed for young adults trying to quit vaping. It sends you texts based on your quit date and helps talk you off the ledge when cravings hit.

Since you go through a disposable every 4-5 days, your body is very used to having nicotine around. How are you feeling about this, do you want to try tapering down the nicotine using patches/gum, or are you thinking about just setting a date, throwing them out, and ripping the band-aid off?

End of packet. Go to the next tab on your Start here list.